

# Word family: **moment / moments / momentary / momentarily / momentous / momentum**

**Base word:** moment

**Plural:** moments

**Part of speech:** mainly **noun**

**Related forms:**

**momentary** (adj.) — 短暫的；瞬間的

**momentarily** (adv.) — 短暫地；片刻間

**momentous** (adj.) — 重大的；極重要的

**moment** in fixed expressions:

**at the moment**

**for a moment**

**in a moment**

**the moment**

**from that moment on**

**a defining moment**

**a turning point / pivotal moment**

**a moment of truth**

**a moment's notice**

**not for a moment**

**any moment now**

**of the moment**

**Important family note:**

**momentum** looks related historically, but in modern learner vocabulary it has developed into a distinct lexical item meaning **動量 / 勢頭**. I would not merge its full polysemy into the **moment** entry.

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## Meaning in this passage

> That **moment** spoke volumes.

Here, **moment** means:

### **a particular short event or point in time that is memorable or significant — 一個特定的時刻；那一刻**

The speaker refers to the exact situation when Leo responded calmly after his cardboard bridge was broken.

So:

### \*\*that moment = 那一刻 / 那個情境\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯：\*\*

\*\*那一刻\*\*已經說明了很多事情。

More naturally:

> \*\*那一刻\*\*已經充分反映出他的性格。 \*\*

Here, \*\*moment\*\* is not merely “a very short amount of time.” It refers to a \*\*particular meaningful incident\*\*.

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# 1. \*\*moment ( 短暫的一刻 ) — 片刻；瞬間\*\*

This is the basic time sense.

### Practice 1

> She was silent for a \*\*moment\*\*.

她沉默了\*\*片刻\*\*。

### Practice 2

> For a \*\*moment\*\*, I didn't know what to say.

有那麼\*\*一瞬間\*\*，我不知道該說甚麼。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*moment = 一段非常短的時間；片刻\*\*

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# 2. \*\*a particular moment ( 某個特定時刻 ) — 時刻；一刻\*\*

This is especially relevant to your passage.

### Practice 1 — passage sense

> That \*\*moment\*\* spoke volumes.

\*\*那一刻\*\*已經說明了很多事情。

#### ### Practice 2

> I still remember the **moment** I first met her.

我仍然記得第一次見到她的**那一刻**。

#### ### Practice 3

> It was a **moment** I would never forget.

那是我永遠不會忘記的**一刻**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**moment** = 某件特定事情發生的那個時刻或短暫情境

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# 3. **a memorable / special moment** — 難忘 / 特別的時刻

#### ### Practice 1

> Winning the competition was a very special **moment** for her.

贏得比賽對她來說是一個非常特別的**時刻**。

#### ### Practice 2

> It was one of the happiest **moments** of my life.

那是我人生中最開心的**時刻之一**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**moment** = 因具有情感或重要性而值得記住的短暫時刻

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# 4. **a difficult / awkward / emotional moment** — 一個困難 / 尷尬 / 情緒強烈的時刻

#### ### Practice 1

> There was an awkward **moment** when nobody knew what to say.

有一個很**尷尬的時刻**，大家都不知道該說甚麼。

#### ### Practice 2

> It was an emotional **moment** for the whole family.

那對全家來說都是一個**情緒非常強烈的時刻**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**moment = 某段具有特定情緒或情境特徵的短暫時間**

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# 5. **at the moment** — 目前；現在

A very common expression.

### Practice 1

> I'm quite busy **at the moment**.

我**目前**很忙。

### Practice 2

> She's not working **at the moment**.

她**現在**沒有工作。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**at the moment = 在目前這段時間；現在**

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# 6. **for the moment** — 暫時；目前

This means something is true **for now**, possibly not permanently.

### Practice 1

> Let's leave things as they are **for the moment**.

我們**暫時**先維持現狀吧。

### Practice 2

> The problem has been solved **for the moment**.

這個問題**暫時**已經解決。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*for the moment = 暫時如此，之後可能改變\*\***

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# 7. **\*\*for a moment — 一會兒；片刻\*\***

**### Practice 1**

> Can you wait here **\*\*for a moment\*\***?

你可以在這裏等**\*\*一會兒\*\***嗎？

**### Practice 2**

> She closed her eyes **\*\*for a moment\*\***.

她閉上眼睛**\*\*片刻\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*for a moment = 持續很短的一段時間\*\***

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# 8. **\*\*in a moment — 一會兒之後；馬上\*\***

**### Practice 1**

> I'll be ready **\*\*in a moment\*\***.

我**\*\*很快 / 一會兒\*\***就準備好。

**### Practice 2**

> The doctor will see you **\*\*in a moment\*\***.

醫生**\*\*很快\*\***就會見你。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*in a moment = 過很短時間之後；很快\*\***

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# 9. **\*\*the moment (that)... — .....就.....\*\***

Here **the moment** functions almost like **as soon as**.

#### Practice 1

> **The moment I saw him**, I knew something was wrong.

**我一看到他**，就知道有些不對勁。

#### Practice 2

> Call me **the moment you arrive**.

你**一到達**就打電話給我。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**the moment (that) X happens = X — 發生，就立即.....**

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# 10. **from that moment on — 從那一刻起**

#### Practice 1

> **From that moment on**, everything changed.

**從那一刻起**，一切都改變了。

#### Practice 2

> **From that moment on**, they became close friends.

**從那一刻起**，他們成為了親密朋友。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**from that moment on = 從某個特定時刻開始，之後一直如此**

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# 11. **at that moment — 就在那一刻**

#### Practice 1

> **At that moment**, the phone rang.

**就在那一刻**，電話響了。

### ### Practice 2

> I realized **at that moment** that I had made a mistake.

我**就在那一刻**意識到自己犯了錯。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**at that moment** = 在那個特定時間點

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# 12. **at any moment** — 隨時；任何時刻

### ### Practice 1

> The train could arrive **at any moment**.

火車**隨時**都可能到。

### ### Practice 2

> It looked as if it might start raining **at any moment**.

看起來**隨時**都可能下雨。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**at any moment** = 在非常接近現在的任何時候；隨時

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# 13. **any moment now** — 隨時就會；馬上

### ### Practice 1

> She should be here **any moment now**.

她應該**隨時就會到**。

### ### Practice 2

> The announcement could come **any moment now**.

公布結果**隨時**都可能出來。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**any moment now** = 預期某件事很快就會發生

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# 14. \*\*a moment ago — 剛才；片刻之前\*\*

### Practice 1

> He was here \*\*a moment ago\*\*.

他\*\*剛才\*\*還在這裏。

### Practice 2

> I saw her \*\*a moment ago\*\*.

我\*\*剛剛\*\*見過她。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*a moment ago = 很短時間以前；剛才\*\*

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# 15. \*\*wait a moment / just a moment — 等一下\*\*

### Practice 1

> \*\*Just a moment\*\*, please.

請\*\*等一下\*\*。

### Practice 2

> \*\*Wait a moment\*\*—I forgot my bag.

\*\*等一下\*\*，我忘了拿袋。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*just/wait a moment = 要求別人短暫等待\*\*

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# 16. \*\*one moment — 請稍等\*\*

Often used politely in service situations.

### Practice 1

> **One moment**, please. I'll check for you.

請**稍等一下**，我幫你查。

#### ### Practice 2

> **One moment**, sir. Your table will be ready shortly.

先生，請**稍等片刻**，你的桌子很快就準備好。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**one moment** = 禮貌地要求對方等一小會兒

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# 17. **a defining moment** — 決定性時刻；具有重大影響的一刻

#### ### Practice 1

> The victory became a **defining moment** in her career.

那次勝利成為她事業中的一個**關鍵時刻**。

#### ### Practice 2

> His decision was a **defining moment** for the company.

他的決定是公司發展中的一個**決定性時刻**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**defining moment** = 對日後發展、身分或方向產生重大影響的關鍵時刻

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# 18. **a pivotal / crucial moment** — 關鍵時刻

#### ### Practice 1

> This was a **pivotal moment** in the project.

這是項目中的一個**關鍵時刻**。

#### ### Practice 2

> She remained calm at a **crucial moment**.

她在\*\*關鍵時刻\*\*保持冷靜。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*pivotal/crucial moment = 對結果有重大影響的重要時刻\*\*

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# 19. \*\*a historic moment — 歷史性時刻\*\*

### Practice 1

> Millions watched the \*\*historic moment\*\* on television.

數百萬人透過電視觀看這個\*\*歷史性時刻\*\*。

### Practice 2

> It was a \*\*historic moment\*\* for the organization.

那是該組織的一個\*\*歷史性時刻\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*historic moment = 因具有重大歷史意義而值得長久記錄的時刻\*\*

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# 20. \*\*a moment of truth — 真相揭曉 / 接受考驗的關鍵時刻\*\*

A very useful fixed expression.

### Practice 1

> The final interview was the \*\*moment of truth\*\*.

最後面試就是\*\*真正考驗成敗的關鍵時刻\*\*。

### Practice 2

> The \*\*moment of truth\*\* came when the results were announced.

公布結果時，真正的\*\*關鍵時刻\*\*來到了。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*moment of truth = 真正結果、能力或真相即將被揭示的決定性時刻\*\*

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# 21. **\*\*a moment's notice — 極短通知；臨時通知\*\***

Usually in:

### **\*\*at a moment's notice\*\***

### Practice 1

> She is ready to travel **\*\*at a moment's notice\*\***.

她可以**\*\*接到通知後立即\*\***出發。

### Practice 2

> Staff may be required to work late **\*\*at a moment's notice\*\***.

員工可能會在**\*\*臨時通知下\*\***被要求加班。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*at a moment's notice = 幾乎沒有預先通知，就立即需要行動\*\***

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# 22. **\*\*not for a moment — 一刻也不；完全沒有\*\***

### Practice 1

> I did **\*\*not for a moment\*\*** believe he was lying.

我**\*\*一刻也沒有\*\***相信他在說謊。

### Practice 2

> She never **\*\*for a moment\*\*** considered giving up.

她**\*\*從來沒有一刻\*\***想過放棄。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*not for a moment = 完全沒有，即使很短時間也沒有\*\***

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# 23. **\*\*of the moment — 當下最受注目的；時下流行的\*\***

### ### Practice 1

> She is one of the actors **of the moment**.

她是**當下最受注目的演員之一**。

### ### Practice 2

> This is the fashion trend **of the moment**.

這是**時下最流行的時尚趨勢**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**of the moment** = 在目前這段時間特別流行、成功或受關注的

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# 24. **the moment passes** — 那一刻 / 機會過去

### ### Practice 1

> I wanted to say something, but the **moment passed**.

我本來想說些甚麼，但**時機已經過去了**。

### ### Practice 2

> If you hesitate too long, the **moment may pass**.

如果你猶豫太久，**合適的時機可能會溜走**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**the moment passes** = 某個適合行動或具有特殊意義的短暫時機結束

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# 25. **seize the moment** — 把握當下 / 時機

### ### Practice 1

> She decided to **seize the moment** and tell him how she felt.

她決定**把握時機**，告訴他自己的感受。

### ### Practice 2

> You have to **seize the moment** when an opportunity appears.

機會出現時，你要懂得**把握當下**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**seize the moment** = 把握眼前適合行動的短暫機會

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# 26. **live in the moment** — 活在當下

### Practice 1

> Children are often better at **living in the moment** than adults.

孩子往往比成年人更懂得**活在當下**。

### Practice 2

> Try to relax and **live in the moment**.

試着放鬆，**享受當下**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**live in the moment** = 把注意力放在現在的經歷，而不是一直擔心過去或未來

This actually fits your Leo passage rather nicely.

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# 27. **momentary** — 短暫的；一瞬間的

### Practice 1

> There was a **momentary silence**.

現場出現了**短暫的沉默**。

### Practice 2

> She felt a **momentary sense of panic**.

她有一瞬間感到**短暫的恐慌**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**momentary** = 只持續非常短時間的

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# 28. \*\*momentarily — 短暫地；片刻間\*\*

#### ### Practice 1

> He was \*\*momentarily confused\*\*.

他\*\*一時間\*\*感到困惑。

#### ### Practice 2

> The lights went out \*\*momentarily\*\*.

燈光\*\*短暫地\*\*熄滅了。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*momentarily = 持續很短時間地\*\*

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# 29. \*\*momentarily ( AmE : 很快；馬上 ) — 很快；片刻後\*\*

There is an important regional usage.

In \*\*American English\*\*, \*\*momentarily\*\* can also mean \*\*very soon\*\*.

#### ### Practice 1

> The train will arrive \*\*momentarily\*\*.

火車\*\*很快就會到達\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> We will begin \*\*momentarily\*\*.

我們\*\*馬上就會開始\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*momentarily = 很快、片刻之後 ( 尤其美式英語 ) \*\*

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# 30. \*\*momentous — 重大的；意義深遠的\*\*

Despite its appearance, **momentous** does **not** mean “lasting for a moment.”

It means **very important**.

#### ### Practice 1

> It was a **momentous decision**.

那是一個**極其重大的決定**。

#### ### Practice 2

> The country was going through a **momentous period of change**.

那個國家正經歷一段**意義重大的變革時期**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**momentous = 非常重要，而且可能帶來長遠重大影響的**

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# Important distinction 1: **moment vs minute**

#### ### **moment**

usually an **indefinite very short time**.

> Wait a **moment**.

等一下。

#### ### **minute**

can literally mean **60 seconds**, although conversationally it can also mean a short time.

> Wait a **minute**.

等一下。

So in everyday speech they can overlap, but **moment** does not specify an exact duration.

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# Important distinction 2: **moment vs second**

### \*\*second\*\*

literally a precise unit of time.

### \*\*moment\*\*

a vague short period or particular meaningful instant.

> I'll be there in a \*\*second\*\*.

我馬上到。

> It was a beautiful \*\*moment\*\*.

那是美好的一刻。

You would not normally replace \*\*moment\*\* with \*\*second\*\* in the second sentence because the meaning is emotional/event-based.

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# Important distinction 3: \*\*moment vs occasion\*\*

### \*\*moment\*\*

focuses on a particular \*\*point or brief period in time\*\*.

### \*\*occasion\*\*

focuses on an \*\*event or situation\*\*, often longer.

> At that \*\*moment\*\*, he smiled.

就在那一刻，他笑了。

> It was a special \*\*occasion\*\* for the whole family.

那是全家的一個特別場合。

In your passage, \*\*moment\*\* focuses on the exact instant Leo responded.

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# Important distinction 4: \*\*moment vs event\*\*

An \*\*event\*\* is something that happens.

A **moment** emphasizes the particular point in time or short scene within the event.

The family gathering was an **event**.

Leo saying:

> "That's okay, we can build a better one."

was the significant **moment** inside that event.

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# Important distinction 5: **at the moment** vs **at that moment**

### **at the moment**

= **now / currently**

> I'm busy **at the moment**.

我現在很忙。

### **at that moment**

= at a specific point in the past or narrative

> **At that moment**, Leo smiled.

就在那一刻，Leo 笑了。

This distinction is very important.

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# Important distinction 6: **for a moment** vs **in a moment**

### **for a moment**

duration:

> Wait **for a moment**.

等一會兒。

### **in a moment**

future time:

> I'll come back **\*\*in a moment\*\***.

我一會兒就回來。

So:

\* **\*\*for\*\*** → how long

\* **\*\*in\*\*** → how soon

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# Important distinction 7: **\*\*at the moment vs for the moment\*\***

### **\*\*at the moment\*\***

= currently

> I'm staying with my parents **\*\*at the moment\*\***.

我目前跟父母住。

### **\*\*for the moment\*\***

= temporarily, for now

> Let's leave it there **\*\*for the moment\*\***.

我們暫時先這樣。

The second more clearly implies possible future change.

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# Important distinction 8: **\*\*the moment vs a moment\*\***

### **\*\*a moment\*\***

one short period

> Wait **\*\*a moment\*\***.

等一下。

### \*\*the moment + clause\*\*

immediately when

> \*\*The moment he arrived\*\*, everyone started talking.

他一到，大家就開始說話。

Completely different grammar.

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# Important distinction 9: \*\*momentary vs momentous\*\*

These are extremely easy to confuse.

### \*\*momentary\*\*

= very brief

> a \*\*momentary pause\*\*

短暫停頓

### \*\*momentous\*\*

= extremely important

> a \*\*momentous decision\*\*

重大決定

So:

### \*\*momentary ≠ momentous\*\*

This is a very worthwhile learner contrast.

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# Important distinction 10: \*\*moment vs memory\*\*

### \*\*moment\*\*

the actual point/event in time

### \*\*memory\*\*

what remains in your mind afterward

> It was a beautiful \*\*moment\*\*.

那是一個美好的時刻。

> It became a beautiful \*\*memory\*\*.

它後來成為一段美好的回憶。

A \*\*moment\*\* can later become a \*\*memory\*\*.

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# Important distinction 11: \*\*a moment of X\*\*

This pattern often means:

### \*\*a short period characterized by X\*\*

Examples:

\* \*\*a moment of silence\*\* — 一刻沉默

\* \*\*a moment of panic\*\* — 一瞬間恐慌

\* \*\*a moment of hesitation\*\* — 一瞬間猶豫

\* \*\*a moment of kindness\*\* — 一刻善意

These are not separate dictionary meanings of \*\*moment\*\*; the following noun tells us what characterized that short period.

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# Important distinction 12: \*\*that moment vs that time\*\*

### \*\*that moment\*\*

usually points to a \*\*very specific instant\*\*.

### \*\*that time\*\*

can refer to a broader occasion or period.

> At \*\*that moment\*\*, he smiled.

就在\*\*那一刻\*\*，他笑了。

> At \*\*that time\*\*, I was living abroad.

在\*\*那段時間 / 當時\*\*，我住在外國。

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# Family-extension note

\*\*Moment\*\* has a relatively compact semantic core:

### \*\*a short period or particular point in time\*\*

From there, several important learner branches develop:

1. \*\*brief duration\*\*

- \* for a moment
- \* wait a moment

2. \*\*particular point in time\*\*

- \* at that moment
- \* the moment I saw him

3. \*\*meaningful/significant incident\*\*

- \* a special moment
- \* a defining moment
- \* that moment spoke volumes

4. \*\*current time\*\*

- \* at the moment
- \* for the moment

5. \*\*immediate timing constructions\*\*

- \* in a moment
- \* the moment that...
- \* any moment now

6. \*\*figurative opportunity/significance\*\*

- \* seize the moment

- \* live in the moment
- \* moment of truth

The adjective family also contains an especially important contrast:

- \* **momentary** = 短暫的
- \* **momentous** = 重大的

Those should absolutely be separated in learner materials.

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## # Master comparison

| Form / expression           | Traditional Chinese | Core idea                       |  |
|-----------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------|--|
| -----                       | -----               | -----                           |  |
| <b>a moment</b>             | 片刻；一瞬間              | short time                      |  |
| <b>that moment</b>          | 那一刻                 | specific point                  |  |
| <b>special moment</b>       | 特別的時刻               | meaningful instant              |  |
| <b>emotional moment</b>     | 情緒強烈的時刻             | emotionally marked time         |  |
| <b>at the moment</b>        | 目前；現在               | current time                    |  |
| <b>for the moment</b>       | 暫時                  | for now                         |  |
| <b>for a moment</b>         | 一會兒                 | brief duration                  |  |
| <b>in a moment</b>          | 一會兒之後               | very soon                       |  |
| <b>the moment X...</b>      | X — .....就.....     | immediately when                |  |
| <b>from that moment on</b>  | 從那一刻起               | from then onward                |  |
| <b>at that moment</b>       | 就在那一刻               | specific instant                |  |
| <b>at any moment</b>        | 隨時                  | any time soon                   |  |
| <b>any moment now</b>       | 隨時就會                | imminently                      |  |
| <b>a moment ago</b>         | 剛才                  | very recently                   |  |
| <b>just/one moment</b>      | 等一下                 | polite request to wait          |  |
| <b>defining moment</b>      | 決定性時刻               | shapes future                   |  |
| <b>pivotal moment</b>       | 關鍵時刻                | critical point                  |  |
| <b>historic moment</b>      | 歷史性時刻               | historically important          |  |
| <b>moment of truth</b>      | 真相 / 成敗揭曉的時刻        | decisive test                   |  |
| <b>at a moment's notice</b> | 臨時通知下立即             | almost no warning               |  |
| <b>not for a moment</b>     | 一刻也不                | absolutely not                  |  |
| <b>of the moment</b>        | 當下最受注目的             | currently fashionable/prominent |  |
| <b>seize the moment</b>     | 把握時機                | act on opportunity              |  |
| <b>live in the moment</b>   | 活在當下                | focus on present                |  |
| <b>momentary</b>            | 短暫的                 | brief                           |  |
| <b>momentarily</b>          | 短暫地 / 很快            | briefly / soon in AmE           |  |
| <b>momentous</b>            | 重大的                 | highly important                |  |

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### For your original sentence

> That **moment** spoke volumes.

Here:

### **moment = 那一刻 ; 那個短暫但很有意義的情境**

It refers specifically to the point when:

- \* Leo's cardboard bridge was accidentally broken;
- \* the speaker expected him to cry;
- \* Leo instead smiled and said, "That's okay, we can build a better one."

So **moment** here is not merely "a tiny unit of time." It means:

### **a particular short incident that reveals something important about a person**

That is why:

> **That moment spoke volumes.**

naturally means:

> **那一刻已經充分反映出他的性格。**

The key sense for this passage is therefore **「一個具有意義、能反映人物性格的特定時刻」**.